SPEED-TO-LEAD · BD SYSTEMS · 30-DAY PLAN

The BD *Action* Manual

Build a lead system that works without you. The exact framework, scripts, and 30-day plan to close the speed-to-lead gap and turn missed leads into predictable revenue.

INCLUDES
7-LEVER DIAGNOSTIC · GTM FRAMEWORK · 30-DAY ACTION PLAN · SCRIPTS

€97
ACTION MANUAL

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THE CORE PROBLEM

Your monthly revenue leak — *calculate it now*

01

> Most business owners don't have a lead problem. They have a lead handling problem. And it costs them money every single month without ever showing up on a P&L.

78%	21×	4–48h
OF SERVICE LEADS GO WITH THE FIRST PROVIDER TO RESPOND	HIGHER CLOSE RATE WHEN YOU RESPOND WITHIN 5 MINUTES VS. 30 MINUTES	AVERAGE RESPONSE TIME OF SERVICE BUSINESSES. THAT GAP IS YOUR OPPORTUNITY.

The pattern is always the same. You are good at what you do. Clients come through referrals. The calendar stays full. And exactly when you want to grow, you hit the wall — because the bottleneck is you.

Leads come in. Nobody responds fast enough. Some fall through the cracks. The ones that do get a reply receive a generic message. You follow up once, maybe twice, then move on.

RUN THIS CALCULATION BEFORE YOU CONTINUE

How many leads reach you per month? × What is your average deal value? × Your current close rate?

Now: what if your response time dropped from 24 hours to 5 minutes and you followed up 5 times instead of once? Research consistently shows this improves close rates by **30–50% for service businesses.**

That delta — multiplied by 12 — is your annual revenue leak. Write it down.

"The business that responds fastest and most personally wins the deal. Not the best product, the lowest price, or

the biggest budget."

LEAD IT, GROW — BD SYSTEMS PRINCIPLE

This manual is built around seven BD levers. Score yourself on each before reading further. Your top three gaps are your 30-day focus. The rest can wait.

BD LEVER	SCORE 0-3 (0 = STRONG, 3 = CRITICAL GAP)
Speed-to-lead	How fast do you respond to new enquiries?
Pipeline follow-up	Do leads hear from you more than once if they go quiet?
Online presence	Does your website attract and convert your ideal client?
Sales close rate	What percentage of conversations turn into clients?
Owner time	Can you take a week off without the business stalling?
Leadership and team autonomy	Does your team handle leads without you?
Client retention and referrals	Do happy clients bring you new ones?

LEVER 1

02

Speed-to-Lead: *the 5-minute rule*

> The moment a lead contacts you, they are looking at 2–3 competitors. Your response time determines whether you are in the conversation at all.

This is not about being pushy. It is about showing up while the person still cares. At 5 minutes, you are first. At 4 hours, you are third. At 24 hours, they have probably already booked a call with someone else.

The 5-minute acknowledgement

This is not a long personalised email. It is a human signal that you showed up.

> *Hi [Name], I just saw your message — thanks for reaching out. I'm in the middle of something but I did not want to leave you waiting. I'll send you a proper reply within the hour. If it is easier to just talk, I have a spot open [DAY] at [TIME] for a quick 15-minute call. What works for you?*

This does three things: you showed up fast, you sound human, and you moved straight to a meeting instead of a back-and-forth.

If you cannot always respond that fast

Automate the first response. When a lead submits your contact form, they immediately receive a personal-sounding email that acknowledges them by name, confirms you received their message, and proposes 2–3 concrete time slots. It sounds like you wrote it — because in a sense, you did. You just wrote it once.

QUICK WIN

Phone notification

Set up an instant notification for every new form submission. This

QUICK WIN

Saved template

Write your 5-minute acknowledgement once. Save it on

QUICK WIN

Lead triage block

Block 9:00–9:15 and 14:00–14:15 daily for lead triage only. Nothing else happens in those 15 minutes.

alone cuts average response time from hours to minutes.	your phone. Copy, personalise the name, send. 45 seconds.	

FOR HIGH-VALUE LEADS SPECIFICALLY

If a lead is clearly high-value — large company, specific brief, strong ICP match — consider a short personalised video message (Loom, free) alongside your email. A 45-second video referencing something specific from their message gets roughly **3x the reply rate of text alone.** This is not a standard first-response tactic — it is a tool for the top 10% of leads that justify the extra 5 minutes.

WEEK 1 — ACTIONS

- ☐ **Set up email notification** for all new form submissions on your website
- ☐ **Write your 5-minute template** and save it on your phone today
- ☐ **Submit your own contact form** and time how long before an email lands in your inbox
- ☐ **Optional:** Set up automated first response via Make, ActiveCampaign, or a custom system

LEVER 2

Pipeline Follow-Up: *the 5-touch sequence*

03

> 80% of sales happen between the 5th and 12th contact. Most business owners stop after the first or second. That is where the money leaks.

Most follow-up fails because it is reactive. You remember to follow up when you happen to think about it. A sequence is pre-written, pre-scheduled, and runs whether you remember or not.

TOUCH	TIMING	MESSAGE FOCUS
Touch 1	Immediately	First reply with 2–3 specific time slot proposals
Touch 2	2 hours later	Short check-in — "did my email arrive?" One question.
Touch 3	Day 2	Different angle — add value, reference their specific situation
Touch 4	Day 5	Soft check-in — no pressure, still available
Touch 5	Day 14	The break-up email — gives them an easy way back in

The most important touch is number 2 — the 2-hour follow-up. Most people think it is too aggressive. It is not. At 2 hours, the lead is still thinking about their problem. You are still top of mind.

Touch 2 — the 2-hour follow-up

> *Hi [Name], I just wanted to make sure my first email came through — sometimes these end up in spam. I have a spot open this [day] at [time] for a quick 15-minute call. If the timing is off, no pressure at all.*

Touch 3 — add value, not pressure

> *Hi [Name], I was thinking about what you mentioned — [reference their specific situation]. I put together a quick note on [relevant topic] that might be useful regardless of whether we work together. Happy to share it on the call. Still on for [proposed slot]?*

Touch 5 — the break-up email

> *Hi [Name], I have reached out a few times and have not heard back, so I am going to assume the timing is not right. I will close out your enquiry — no problem at all. If anything changes, you know where to find me. Good luck with everything.*

WHY THIS WORKS

Half the people who receive the break-up email reply within 24 hours. It works because it removes all pressure and gives them an easy way back in. **The absence of pressure is itself persuasive.**

WEEK 2 — ACTIONS

- ☐ **Write all 5 templates** in your own voice — not copy-pasted, genuinely yours
- ☐ **Set up the sequence** in your email tool or as calendar reminders
- ☐ **Calculate:** what percentage of last month's leads heard from you more than twice?
- ☐ **Test the sequence** on your next 3 new leads

LEVER 3

Online Presence: *your funnel, your data*

04

> Your website is not a brochure. It is a funnel. And you cannot optimise a funnel you are not measuring.

Most service business websites are designed to impress. The good ones are designed to convert. There is a difference. One is about you. The other is about what happens when a visitor arrives — where they go, what they read, whether they take the next step.

Map your funnel first

Draw this on paper right now. At each arrow, write your current conversion rate.

STEP 1	**Visitor arrives** Where do they come from? Google, referral, social? Which channel brings the best leads — not just the most traffic?	TOOL **GA4 + Search Console**
STEP 2	**5-second test** Can a stranger understand who you help, what you do, and what to do next — from above the fold alone?	FIX **Rewrite headline**
STEP 3	**CTA click** One clear call to action. Not three, not a menu. The best-performing for service businesses: "Book a free 15-min call" or "Get your free diagnostic."	TARGET **1 CTA, above fold**
STEP 4	**Form submission** Is your form tracking correctly? Most GA4 installs track page views but not form submissions. That means you are flying blind on your most important conversion.	CHECK **GA4 goal event**
STEP 5	**Lead to client** What percentage of form submissions become paying clients? Which channel produces the highest-quality leads? You need CRM data to answer this.	TARGET **20–40% form-to-call**

The minimum viable tracking stack

TOOL	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	COST
Google Analytics 4	Traffic sources, page behaviour, where visitors drop off	Free
Google Search Console	Which search terms bring people to you, click-through rates	Free
GA4 form event	When your contact form is submitted — the single most important conversion	Free
Hotjar (free tier)	Session recordings — watch exactly what visitors do on your page	Free

THE HEADLINE FORMULA THAT WORKS

Most headlines say "Welcome to [Company]." Write for the reader instead.

Formula: "I help [specific person] do [specific outcome] without [specific frustration]."

Example: "I help service businesses respond to every lead within 5 minutes, automatically." — One sentence. Zero ambiguity.

WEEK 3 — ACTIONS

- ☐ **Do the 5-second test** on your homepage right now
- ☐ **Rewrite your headline** using the formula above
- ☐ **Submit your own contact form** and verify the email arrives and is tracked
- ☐ **Check GA4:** are form submissions tracked as goal events? If not, fix this first
- ☐ **Add one piece of social proof** (testimonial or result) above the fold

LEVER 4

Sales Close Rate: *the discovery framework*

05

> Close rate problems almost never come from price. They come from solving your problem in the call instead of theirs — and from not making the cost of inaction concrete enough to create urgency.

The most effective sales conversations are discovery-first. The business that understands the buyer's situation best — not the one with the slickest pitch — wins the deal.

The cost of inaction — use this before you pitch

Before presenting your solution, help the prospect quantify what it costs them to do nothing. This is not manipulation. It is clarity.

THE CALCULATION TO RUN IN EVERY DISCOVERY CALL

"If this problem is still the same in 90 days, what does that cost you in lost revenue or wasted time?"

Help them do the maths out loud. When a prospect says **"this is costing me €4,000 a month,"** your €1,200 service does not feel like an expense. It feels like a return. They did the calculation themselves — you did not push it on them.

The 4-question discovery framework

QUESTION 1

Situation

"What does your current process look like for [the thing you solve]?" Listen. Do not correct it yet.

QUESTION 2

Problem

"Where does that break down? What's the most frustrating part?" This is the language to use in your proposal.

QUESTION 3

Impact

"What does that cost you in time, revenue or stress?" Help them quantify. Most people have never done the maths.

QUESTION 4

Timeline

"If this is still the same in 90 days, is that acceptable?" A "no" here means you have a motivated buyer.

The call structure (30 minutes)

TIME	WHAT HAPPENS
0–2 min	Set the agenda. "Here's what I was thinking for our time today — does that work?"
2–15 min	Discovery only. Run the 4 questions. Do not pitch yet.
15–22 min	Connect what you heard to what you do — specifically the part that solves their stated problem.
22–28 min	Handle the most common objections before they raise them.
28–30 min	Propose the next step with a specific date. Not "I'll send you something." A date.

Objection scripts

"IT'S TOO EXPENSIVE."

"That's fair — let's look at the numbers together. You mentioned this problem is costing you roughly [X] per month. If we solve it, the investment pays back in [N] months. Does that change the picture at all?"

"I NEED TO THINK ABOUT IT."

"Of course. Can I ask — what specifically do you want to think through? I want to make sure you have the right information before you decide."

"NOW IS NOT THE RIGHT TIME."

"I hear that. What would need to be true for the timing to be right? Is there something specific changing in the next quarter?"

"Based on what we discussed, does this feel like the right next step for you?"

THE ONLY CLOSE YOU NEED. IF NOT YET — ASK: "WHAT WOULD NEED TO BE TRUE FOR IT TO BE A YES?"

WEEK 4 — ACTIONS

- ☐ **Run the 4 discovery questions** on your next three calls — write down what they say
- ☐ **Write down your two most common objections** and prepare your response before the next call
- ☐ **End every call this week** with a proposed next step and a specific date
- ☐ **After each call:** rate the lead hot / warm / cold and log it

LEVERS 5, 6 & 7

06

Growth Loops: *referrals, motions, dream clients*

> A funnel leaks. Every step loses some people. A growth loop compounds. This is where service businesses build the predictable, system-driven growth they keep talking about but never build.

The referral loop

The strongest growth loop for service businesses is the referral loop — and most businesses never activate it because they never ask. The loop looks like this:

STEP 1	**Deliver great work** The foundation. If your clients are not genuinely satisfied, fix this before building any acquisition system.	TIMING **During project**
STEP 2	**Ask directly at day 30** Not during the project. Not at invoice. 30 days after delivery, when they have seen the result and are in a positive frame.	TIMING **Day 30 post-delivery**
STEP 3	**Warm introduction** They introduce you to someone in their network. That person already trusts you before you have said a word. Zero acquisition cost.	CAC **€0**
STEP 4	**Repeat** That new client becomes a referral source. The loop self-reinforces.	EFFECT **Compounds**

The referral ask — use this template

> *Hi [Name], working with you on [project] was exactly the kind of work I enjoy most. If you know anyone who is dealing with something similar and might benefit from a conversation, I would genuinely appreciate an introduction. No pressure — I just wanted to ask directly rather than hope it happens on its own.*

Pick your primary GTM motion

Most businesses try everything. Most channels produce mediocre results for most businesses. The highest-performing businesses pick one primary motion and get very good at it before adding a second.

GTM MOTION	WORKS BEST WHEN	TYPICAL COST
Referral + network	You have happy clients and send the ask consistently	Very low
Outbound (LinkedIn/email)	You know your ICP precisely and can articulate their problem clearly	Medium (time)
Inbound content + SEO	You can write well and have a 6-month horizon	Low but slow
Partnership	Someone in your network serves the same client with a different solution	Very low
Paid ads	You have a proven landing page, proven offer, and conversion data	Budget required

THE 80/20 RULE FOR GTM

Put **80% of your growth energy** into the one motion with the best evidence of working for you. Experiment with a second on the remaining 20%. If you are not sure which is working best, you need more tracking — not more channels.

Build your dream client list

Most outreach is unfocused. A dream client list changes this from reactive to deliberate. Your list: 25–50 companies or people you would genuinely love to have as clients — not "anyone who might need me" but the specific clients where you do your best work and get your strongest results.

FOR EACH CLIENT

Name and company

Basic info. Enough to find them on LinkedIn and know who to contact.

FOR EACH CLIENT

Why they fit

Their specific problem matches your solution. Not "they could

FOR EACH CLIENT

Warm path

A mutual contact, shared community, event, or content they

	probably use me" — a concrete reason.	engage with. Cold outreach without a hook is wasteful.
FOR EACH CLIENT **Priority tier** A = pursue this quarter. B = next quarter. C = when the time is right. Review monthly.		

ONGOING — ACTIONS

- ☐ **Send the referral ask** to your 3 most recent happy clients this week
- ☐ **Write down your primary GTM motion** and commit 80% of your growth time to it
- ☐ **Build your dream client list** — start with 25, review monthly
- ☐ **Set up a 30-60-90 post-project follow-up rhythm** for every client you close

YOUR PLAN

07

30-Day Plan, scripts & *key metrics*

> Not an endless strategy. Twelve concrete actions across four weeks.
> Start with the levers where you scored highest in the self-assessment.

WEEK 1 — SPEED-TO-LEAD

- ☐ **Set up instant lead notifications** for every new form submission
- ☐ **Write your 5-minute acknowledgement template** and save it on your phone
- ☐ **Test your contact form** — submit it yourself and verify the email arrives
- ☐ **Optional:** Set up automated first response

WEEK 2 — PIPELINE FOLLOW-UP

- ☐ **Write all 5 follow-up templates** in your own voice
- ☐ **Set up the sequence** in your email tool or as calendar reminders
- ☐ **Calculate:** what percentage of last month's leads heard from you more than twice?

WEEK 3 — ONLINE PRESENCE AND FUNNEL

- ☐ **Run the 5-second test** on your homepage
- ☐ **Rewrite your headline** using the formula from Chapter 4
- ☐ **Verify GA4 is tracking form submissions** as goal events
- ☐ **Add one piece of social proof above the fold**

WEEK 4 — SYSTEMISE AND LOCK IN

- ☐ **Write your top 3 SOPs** — one page each, for the processes that would break if you went on holiday
- ☐ **Build your dream client list** — start with 25
- ☐ **Send the referral ask** to your 3 most recent happy clients
- ☐ **Schedule your monthly 30-min review:** response time, follow-up rate, close rate

Key metrics — fill in before you start

METRIC	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE	YOUR DAY 1	YOUR DAY 30
Lead response time	Under 5 minutes		
Follow-up touches per lead	4–6 before closing		
Form-to-call conversion rate	20–40%		
Discovery call close rate	30–50%		
Referral rate	1 per 5 clients/year		

NEXT STEP

Ready to *implement?*

This manual gives you the framework. A personalised session gives you the exact steps for your business, your sector, your stage.

FREE	Business Impact Diagnostic
€97	This manual ←
€997-2500	BD Sprint — done-with-you, 4 weeks
RETAINER	Done-for-you — we run the system

TWO WAYS TO WORK WITH ME DIRECTLY

OPTION 1

Strategy Support Call

60 minutes. I map your current lead flow, identify where the money is leaking, and give you a 90-day plan. Working session, not a sales call.

OPTION 2

Website Tracking Audit

Written report with screen recordings. What is tracked, what is missing, and the 3 things to fix first for the most immediate impact on lead quality.

TO BOOK EITHER: jeroen@leaditgrow.be · Subject: "Strategy Call" or "Tracking Audit"

Book a strategy call →

WEBSITE AUDIT